

2.4.1 Buddhism

Religion, peace and justice

Attitudes to war	• Attitudes towards war • The concept of ahimsa
Violence and pacifism	• Attitudes towards the use of violence • Attitudes towards pacifism • Reasons for these attitudes
Crime and punishment	• Concept of justice • Aims of punishment • Attitudes towards capital punishment • Beliefs about the treatment of criminals • Responses to the treatment of criminals
Social injustice	• Concept of social justice and injustice • Beliefs about social injustice • Responses to social injustice

Religion and equality

Principle of equality	• Buddhist teachings about equality, including the rejection of the caste system
Attitudes towards racism	• Different views about prejudice and equality in relation to race • Practices in relation to racism

Attitudes towards gender	• Different views about prejudice and equality in relation to gender • The role of women in Buddhist society
Attitudes to religion	• Attitudes towards other religions with reference to: - Conversion to Buddhism - The attitude of Asoka to non-Buddhists - The status of non-Buddhist religions
Forgiveness and reconciliation	• Beliefs about forgiveness • Impact of beliefs about forgiveness on believers • Beliefs about reconciliation • Impact of beliefs about reconciliation on believers

Religion and the media

Relationship with the media	• The different forms of media • The influence of the media • Portrayal of Buddhism in the media • Portrayal of important religious figures • Responses and attitudes towards films which focus on religious/philosophical messages • Responses and attitudes towards books and comics which focus on religious/philosophical messages
Use of the media	• Using the media to represent Buddhism • To educate both Buddhists and non-Buddhists
Censorship/freedom of speech	• Concept of censorship and freedom of speech • Beliefs and attitudes towards the portrayal of violence and sex • Attitudes and responses to issues raised by freedom of speech